



Standing Committee on Housing and Works meets

The Standing Committee of the National Assembly on Housing and Works met at the Parliament House, Islamabad, under the chairmanship of Maulana Abdul Ghafoor Haideri, MNA. The meeting commenced with the recitation of the Holy Quran, following which the Committee proceeded with the agenda. The minutes of the previous meeting were confirmed, and the Committee thereafter took up the Bill for consideration, “The Islamabad Capital Territory Condominium (Ownership and Management) Bill, 2026” (Government Bill).

During the course of deliberations, the Committee was apprised by the Honourable Federal Minister for Housing and Works that the Bill seeks to address structural deficiencies in Pakistan’s construction sector, particularly the absence of a comprehensive legal framework governing land ownership in high-rise developments and the limited access to housing finance for low- and middle-income groups.

The Committee examined the provisions of the Bill in detail, including the insurance requirement under Section 10. The Honourable Chairman expressed reservations on religious, constitutional, and public policy grounds, observing that conventional insurance entails elements of *riba* (interest) and *maysir* (gambling), which are inconsistent with the injunctions of Islam. In support thereof, reliance was placed on relevant juristic opinions and fatwas, along with reference to the constitutional mandate that no law shall be enacted which is repugnant to the Quran and Sunnah and the State’s policy to eliminate interest-based practices. The Honourable Chairman, on these grounds, preferred to submit a dissenting note. However, the Committee, by majority, recommended that the Bill be passed by the National Assembly.

The meeting was attended by the Honourable Members Mr. Anjum Aqeel Khan, Mr. Ibrar Ahmad (Online), Haji Rasool Bux Chandio, Ms. Samina Khalid Ghurki, Mr. Anwar-ul-Haq Chaudhry, Mr. Usman Ali, Mr. Nasir Iqbal Bosal, Dr. Darshan, Mir Amir Ali Khan Magsi, and the Honourable Federal Minister for Housing and Works. The Secretary, Ministry of Housing and Works, along with officers of its attached departments, Ministry of Law & Justice also attended the meeting.